

STATE OF NEW YORK

5225--A

2025-2026 Regular Sessions

IN SENATE

February 19, 2025

Introduced by Sens. GOUNARDES, SCARCELLA-SPANTON -- read twice and ordered printed, and when printed to be committed to the Committee on Health -- committee discharged, bill amended, ordered reprinted as amended and recommitted to said committee

AN ACT to amend the public health law, in relation to collecting and reporting sexual offense evidence on the statewide electronic tracking system

The People of the State of New York, represented in Senate and Assembly, do enact as follows:

1 Section 1. Paragraph (j) of subdivision 2 of section 2805-i of the
2 public health law, as amended by section 1 of part II of chapter 56 of
3 the laws of 2021, is amended to read as follows:

4 (j) Notwithstanding any other provision in this section, sexual
5 offense evidence shall not continue to be stored where: (i) such
6 evidence is not privileged and law enforcement requests its release, in
7 which case the [~~custodian(s)~~] custodian or custodians shall comply with
8 such request; or (ii) such evidence is privileged and either (A) the
9 alleged sexual offense victim gives permission to release the evidence
10 to law enforcement, upon which law enforcement must retrieve the
11 evidence within seven days of such permission and report such evidence
12 in the statewide electronic tracking system pursuant to subdivision
13 eight of this section, or (B) the alleged sexual offense victim signs a
14 statement directing the [~~custodian(s)~~] custodian or custodians to
15 dispose of the evidence, in which case the sexual offense evidence will
16 be discarded in compliance with state and local health codes.

17 § 2. Subdivision 8 of section 2805-i of the public health law, as
18 amended by chapter 31 of the laws of 2023, is amended to read as
19 follows:

20 8. (a) The division of criminal justice services in consultation with
21 the department, the office of victim services, the division of state
22 police, and the New York State Coalition Against Sexual Assault shall

EXPLANATION--Matter in italics (underscored) is new; matter in brackets
[~~-~~] is old law to be omitted.

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1 develop a statewide electronic tracking system for reported evidence
2 collection kits used to collect and preserve evidence of a sexual
3 assault or other sex offense [~~that are submitted to the custody of law~~
4 ~~enforcement~~]. Such statewide electronic tracking system shall not
5 include unreported evidence collection kits [~~not in the custody of law~~
6 ~~enforcement~~], provided, however, that any unreported evidence collection
7 kits released by the office of victim services to law enforcement pursu-
8 ant to clause (A) of subparagraph (ii) of paragraph j of subdivision two
9 of this section shall be designated as reported evidence collection kits
10 subject to the tracking requirements set forth in this subdivision.

11 (b) The division of criminal justice services shall promulgate rules
12 and guidelines to ensure that sexual assault evidence collection kits
13 [~~that are submitted to the custody of law enforcement~~] are trackable on
14 a statewide electronic tracking system developed pursuant to this subdivi-
15 sion, and that survivors are given notice of how they may track their
16 own [~~sexual assault~~] reported evidence collection kit [~~after it has been~~
17 ~~submitted to the custody of law enforcement~~]. Such rules and guidelines
18 shall require that (i) hospitals collecting evidence collection kits
19 record the collection of any reported evidence collection kits in the
20 electronic tracking system and notify the appropriate law enforcement
21 agency within forty-eight hours of such collection, and (ii) law
22 enforcement retrieve any reported evidence collection kit from a hospi-
23 tal within seven days of being notified by a hospital that a reported
24 evidence collection kit has been collected. Any hospital, law enforce-
25 ment agency, forensic laboratory, or prosecutor that has taken custody
26 of an evidence collection kit used for a forensic medical examination
27 shall comply with the established protocols, rules and guidelines estab-
28 lished by the division of criminal justice services pursuant to this
29 paragraph.

30 (c) The statewide electronic tracking system shall:

31 (1) Track the location and status of each reported evidence collection
32 kit [~~after such kit has been submitted to the custody of law enforce-~~
33 ~~ment~~] from collection to final disposition;

34 (2) Allow a hospital, law enforcement agency, accredited crime labora-
35 tory, prosecutor, employees of the long-term sexual offense evidence
36 storage facility, or any other entity providing a chain of custody for
37 [~~an~~] a reported evidence collection kit, to update and track the status
38 and location of the reported evidence collection kits [~~that have been~~
39 ~~submitted to the custody of law enforcement~~]; and

40 (3) Allow a survivor to anonymously track or receive updates regarding
41 the status and location of such survivor's reported evidence collection
42 kit [~~that has been submitted to the custody of law enforcement~~].

43 (d) No later than January first, two thousand twenty-five, any hospi-
44 tal, law enforcement agency, accredited crime laboratory, prosecutor,
45 employee of the long-term sexual offense evidence storage facility, or
46 any other entity providing a chain of custody for [~~an~~] a reported
47 evidence collection kit to update and track the status and location of
48 such kit, shall participate in the tracking system and comply with all
49 established protocols, rules and guidelines. A participating entity
50 shall be permitted to access the entity's tracking information through
51 the statewide electronic tracking system.

52 (e) Records entered into the tracking system are confidential. Records
53 relating to [~~an~~] a reported evidence collection kit shall be accessed
54 only by the survivor for whom the reported evidence collection kit was
55 completed.

(f) The provisions of this subdivision shall apply to all reported evidence collection kits submitted prior to, on, or after the effective date of this subdivision.

(g) For purposes of this section:

(1) "evidence collection kit" shall mean a human biological specimen or specimens collected by a healthcare provider during a forensic medical examination from the victim of a sexual assault or other sex offense; ~~and~~

(2) "survivor" shall mean an individual who is the victim of a sexual offense from whom a human biological specimen or specimens collected by a healthcare provider during a forensic medical examination~~[-]~~;

(3) "reported evidence collection kit" means a sexual assault evidence kit in which the survivor has consented to evidence collection and reporting the sexual assault or other sex offense to law enforcement; and

(4) "unreported evidence collection kit" means evidence collection kits controlled by the office of victims services pursuant to paragraph (d) of subdivision two of this section.

§ 3. This act shall take effect immediately. Effective immediately, the addition, amendment and/or repeal of any rule or regulation necessary for the implementation of this act on its effective date are authorized to be made and completed on or before three months of such effective date.